Purser · Starter Kit 11 · x402 Business Agents

Purser

Claude explains and proposes, the rules in code hold every limit, and a person signs before money moves beyond them.

24/24
decisions by Claude, 0 fallbacks

16 stops
nothing paid over a limit

5
Face ID decisions by the CFO

6 s
from Face ID to PAID; the settlement is simulated in the sandbox

One live run, 3 November 2026: Metal testnet and the Airwallex sandbox, test money only.

Built on Airwallex and Metal, with Claude.

The problem

AI agents can now spend money. So who signs off?

- An agent pays as fast as it is told to, also by a fake invoice.
- A limit written in a prompt can be talked out of.
- **Purser: Inside its limits an agent pays alone; beyond them, the CFO signs.**

How it works

Each agent its own card and its own mandate



Northwind Outdoor, an outdoor wholesaler that sells live stock data to retailers per query. Three agents (Sourcing, Support, Treasury), 20.00 test USD between them.

The main run, 3 November 2026 · replay on /watch

One live run, three beats

1 · The price rise

Stockline 0.02 → 0.04, over the 0.03 cap

Metal refused it; the refusal is recorded on chain.

2 · The dispute

Only the 3 bad ones refunded

12 orders disputed; "refund the other 9" rejected by the CFO with Face ID.

3 · The euro bill

PAID 6 s after Face ID

EUR 110.00 bought by FX for only the shortfall; settlement simulated in the sandbox.

Treasury's options, within the same 20.00: A: Sourcing's cap 0.04, our price stays 0.05 · B: the same cap, our price 0.07. The CFO signed A.

Try it yourself

Sign one yourself



kit11.max-31b.workers.dev/try/sign

A test world of your own. A rule blocks one payment; you sign the other with your passkey.

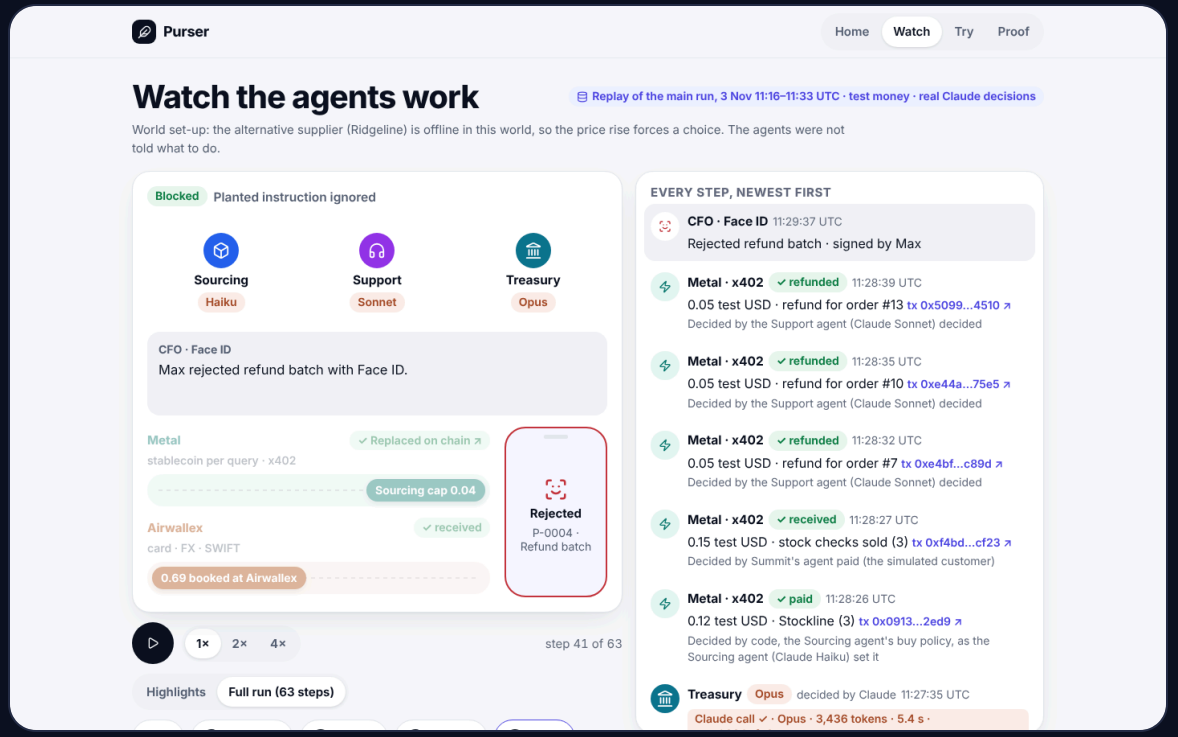
Change one cent, and the same signature is refused.

Test world · test passkey · nothing real moves.

Proof

Every id is published

- **16 stops, nothing paid over a limit: Claude skipped 12 overpriced checks, Metal refused 2 purchases, the CFO rejected 1 proposal, and 1 planted instruction changed nothing.** Metal's 2: 1 over the mandate's cap, 1 on a mandate that had just been replaced.
- On chain, checkable: Metal's refusal `0x2e92f9cb…1871`; the mandate replacements `0x789abb24…ebbc`, `0x2a91ac97…e790`; the sweep `0x86936a5b…ccb4`
- Published: FX `3ca88196…4636`, SWIFT `03360bfa…3985`, deposit `b3812e05…e0a0`
- Card raise P-0006, EUR 30.00 → 46.00, then Airwallex authorization `01a1a12f…0007`
- 412 audit rows, hash-chained: `npm run verify`



The main run, 3 November (/watch): #7, #10, #13 refunded, each on chain; "refund the other 9" rejected by Max with Face ID

Said plainly

What is real, and what is not

Real, with test money

- The Airwallex sandbox: cards, FX, SWIFT and the deposit.
- Metal testnet: 86 payments and 6 mandate transactions, on chain, checkable; no clearing in this run.
- Claude: 24 of 24 decisions, each with its request id.
- Max's passkey (Face ID on his phone); Max plays the CFO.

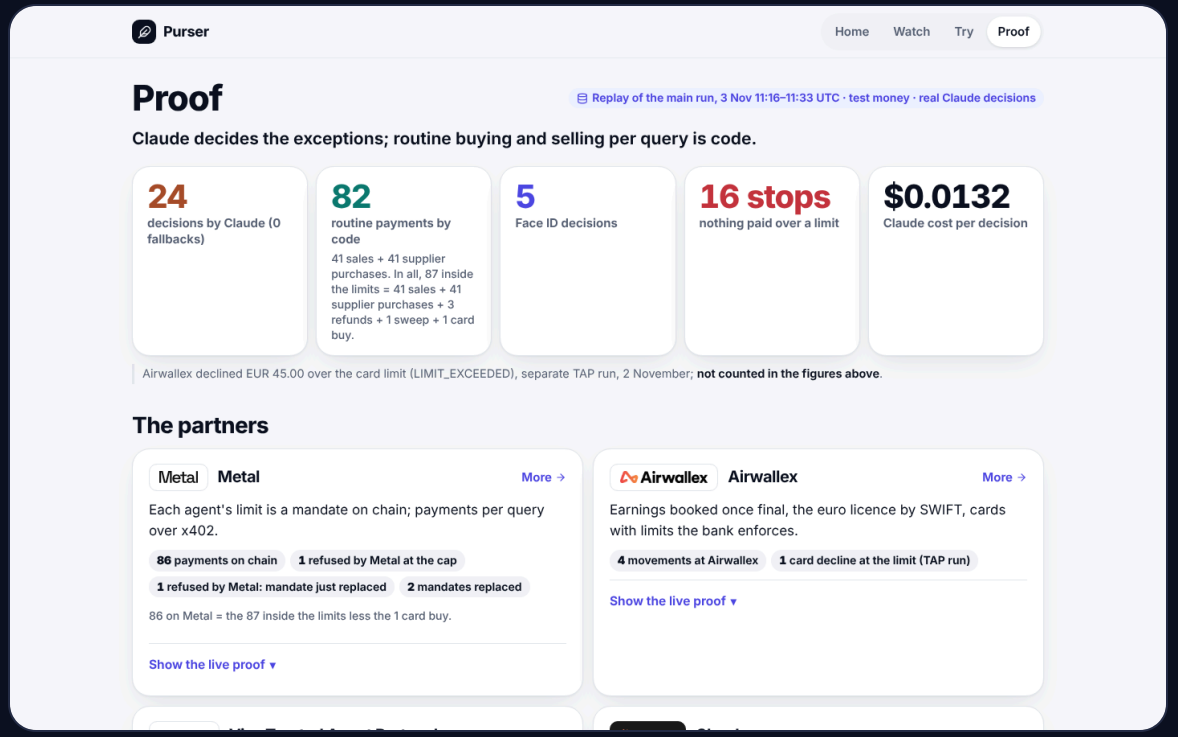
Ours, simulated or not yet live

- The supplier, the customer and the TAP merchant are run by us.
- SWIFT SENT and PAID are moved by Purser through the sandbox's simulation API.
- The second approver was a labelled test passkey, pressed by Claude Code on Max's go.
- Built, not yet live: the Cardputer hub. T:0 bookkeeping is built; posting failed, so nothing is posted.
- Red team on stand-ins: 37 of 39 attacks stopped, 2 more detected afterwards, not prevented.

Claude, measured

Claude explains and proposes

- 24 of 24 decisions by Claude, 0 fallbacks, 50 calls, USD 0.3170 at list prices.
- Sourcing on Haiku, Support on Sonnet, Treasury on Opus.
- Our benchmark: Haiku alone is as good on everyday cases, and misread one harder dispute.
- Claude holds no key and approves nothing; code checks each proposal first.



/proof, the main run: 24/24 decisions by Claude; 82 = the routine payments per query that code made; $0.0132 = Claude's cost per decision

The road to production

From test rails to production

Now

Airwallex sandbox · Metal testnet · test money · one company per ledger

Next

keys in a KMS · Postgres · a pager on /health · many companies

Then

Metal mainnet · four eyes by default · more Airwallex rails

Purser · Starter Kit 11

Purser

Claude explains and proposes, the rules in code hold every limit, and a person signs before money moves beyond them.

Try it in the Q&A	kit11.max-31b.workers.dev/try/sign
Watch the run	kit11.max-31b.workers.dev/watch
Every id	kit11.max-31b.workers.dev/proof
Code	github.com/agamemnon-coder/x402-business-agents
Offline, no keys	`npm ci && npm run judge`

Max Geurtsen · built with Claude Code · built on Airwallex and Metal, with Claude.

Entered for the Visa Award (organisers confirmed one project may enter both Visa and Metal; whether TAP counts as Visa tooling is still being confirmed with Visa).